



This prehistoric shark still lives

With 300 razor sharp teeth, this 80-million year-old "living fossil" looks like it's pulled straight out of your nightmares. <http://dgit.in/PHShark>



Anti-ageing genes

Scientists discover these genes in a secluded Amish community living in Indiana <http://dgit.in/AAGene>

RETHINKING BIOLOGY

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ell, more accurately, everything we know *might* be wrong, or might be right, or *both*, because, you know...

quantum stuff. For the uninitiated, just in case you're wondering what we're on about, anything to do with the quantum world is just inherently confusing and cannot be easily understood or tested. And because everything in the quantum world is neither this nor that, or rather, both this and that, it's pretty much impossible to know anything for sure until we can better understand quantum mechanics.

The field of Quantum Biology is basically the joining of hands of quantum physics and biochemistry to mess with our minds even more than theoretical physics can. Of course some think that quantum biology is really just the typical quantum physicist's ego acting up and wanting to show superiority in yet another field... but we'll avoid this in order to prevent World War III.

WHAT IS IT?

So what's the idea behind quantum biology? Well, as quantum physicists would remind you, everything is just quantum particles in the end. Whether it's a single hydrogen atom or the entire visible universe (which is about a billion light years across), it's all essentially made up of little quantum particles.

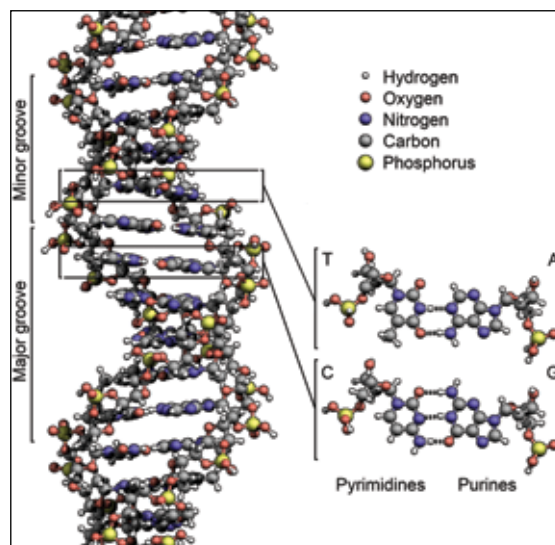
A field of study called quantum biology says everything we know is wrong...

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Now, we've differentiated the science fields by using logic that made sense back when we didn't know that quantum mechanics existed, and so we went by what was visible. Stuff to do with bodies and motion, and mass, etc. was all lumped into physics, anything to do with how elements react with one another by using bonds, and swapping electrons, etc, was lumped into chemistry, and of course, the study of everything living was dumped under biology.

Even with classical science, we have overlapping of sorts. For example, we learned that DNA was just a chemical (a really insane chemical compound, but a mere chemical nonetheless). Then there was always the physics of living things that invaded biology – when you want to know how fast the cheetah runs, it's calculated using physics, even though the question might seem like a biology one.

Because of the overlapping, we had biochemistry and biophysics; what we didn't have was *pbemistry* or *che-mysics*, or whatever... Then, once we discovered that we could observe far smaller things, and then even tinier organisms, etc., we had microbiology. Now, going down to the extreme levels of zoom, and witnessing the tiniest of particles in the quantum world, we finally have the field of quantum biology, which is nothing more than physics, chemistry and biology meeting biochemistry and biophysics, and throwing in quantum mechanics and quantum theory for good measure. Only the string theorists are left alone in the corner wondering about infinite universes...



Just a tiny, tiny sliver of DNA